

2024 VALORANT Game Changers Championship

Competition Ruleset

1. Introduction and Purpose **5**
1.1. Background 5
1.2. Purpose. 5
1.3. Application of the Game Changers Competition Ruleset. 5
1.4. Code of Conduct. 5
1.5. Disciplinary Action. 5
2. Ownership **6**
2.1. Ownership Restrictions 6
2.2. Recognition of Ownership 6
3. Player Eligibility **7**
3.1. Player Age 7
3.2. Player Gender 7
3.3. Eligibility Vouching 7
3.4. Residency & Representation 8
3.5. Verification 9
3.6. Media and Sponsor Events 9
3.7. Player Vetting 10
3.8. No Riot or Tournament Operator Employees 10
4. Roster Rules **11**
4.1. Starters & Substitutes 11
4.2. Minimum Roster Requirements 11
4.2.1. Roster Size. 11
4.3. Single Team Exclusivity 11
4.4. Content Creator Exception 12
4.5. Submission of the Roster & Team Registration 13
4.6. Roster Changes 13
4.7. Substitutions 14
4.8. Team Manager 15
4.9. Team Captain 15
4.10. Coaches 15
4.11. Player Names 17
4.12. Team Tags (Tricodes) 17
5. Competition Format **18**
5.1. Game Changers Championship 18
6. Travel & Expenses **18**
6.1. LAN Events 18
7. Sponsors **18**

7.2. Compliance with Brand Guidelines 20
7.3. Decisions Relating to the Prohibited Sponsorship List 20
7.4. Unauthorized Use of Trademarks 20
8. Uniforms and Apparel 21
8.1. Definitions. 21
8.2. Online Matches 21
8.3. Team Uniform. 21
8.4. Team Jersey. 21
8.5. Legwear. 22
8.6. Shoes. 22
8.7. Optional Apparel. 22
8.8. Prohibited Apparel. 23
8.9. Approved Apparel. 23
8.10. Official Match Walkout Apparel. 23
8.11. League Content. 23
8.12. Coach Apparel. 24
9. Equipment and Peripherals 24
9.1. Team-owned Equipment 24
9.2. Tournament Equipment 25
9.3. Computer Programs and Usage 26
10. Venue, Competition Area Layout, and Schedule 27
10.1. General Venue Access 27
10.2. Pre-Entry Health Inspection 27
11. Match Area 28
11.1. Team Manager and other Team Personnel 28
11.2. Coach Match Area Access 28
11.3. Wireless Devices 29
12. Match Process 30
12.1. Changes to Schedule 30
12.2. Punctuality 30
12.3. Roles of League Officials 30
12.4. Competition Patches 32
12.5. Player Accounts 32
12.7. Pre-Match Setup 33
12.8. Player Ready State & Lobby Creation 33
12.9. Media Obligations. 34
12.10. Lobby Setup & Play Restrictions 34
12.11. Map Selection Process 35
12.12. Agent Select & Match Start 37
12.13. Controlled Match Start 38

12.14. Slow Client Load 38
12.15. Restrictions on Gameplay Elements. 38
13. Post-Match Process 38
13.1. Results 38
13.2. Tech Notes 38
13.3. Between Maps 38
13.4. Between Matches 39
13.5. Post-Match Obligations. 39
13.6. Results of Forfeiture. 39
14. Pauses 39
14.1. Timeouts 39
14.2. Technical Pauses 40
14.3. Player Emergency Pause 41
15. Bugs 41
15.1. Types of Bugs 41
15.1.2. Major Bugs 42
15.2. Use of Round Rollback for Bugs 42
16. Exploit Adjudication 43
16.1. Agent Specific Exploits 43
16.2. Assessment of Penalties 44
16.3. Types of Penalties 45
16.4. Finality of Judgment on Bug and Exploit Adjudication 47
17. Crashes and Interruptions of Gameplay 47
17.1. Discontinuity of Gameplay 47
17.2. Individual Player Gameplay Interruptions 47
17.2.1. Transient Interruptions 47
18. Match Operational Measures 48
18.1. Delay of Game 48
18.2. Non-Compliance 49
19. Limitations of Liability 49
19.1. No Punitive Damages 49
19.2. Cap on Liability 49
20. Dispute Resolution 49
20.1. Finality of Certain Decisions 49
20.2. Remedies 50
21. Prizes 50
21.1. Prize Money 50
22. Construction, Amendments and Other General Provisions 50
22.1. Priority and Conflicts. 50
22.2. Amendments to the Game Changers Competition Ruleset. 51

22.3. Consents and Approvals. 51
22.4. Construction. 51
22.5. Language 52
23. Appendix 1 - Globally Prohibited Sponsorship Categories 53
24. Appendix 2 - Internationally Prohibited Sponsorship Categories 53

1. Introduction and Purpose

1.1. Background

Riot Games, Inc. and/or its affiliate companies (collectively, "**Riot**" or the "**Riot Entities**," or each, a "**Riot Entity**") oversee a series of live and online, locally focused competitions throughout the world ("**Official Competition**") as the "**Tournament Operator**", aimed at creating new opportunities and exposure for women and other marginalized genders within VALORANT esports, collectively referred to as "VALORANT Game Changers Series" (each league, a "**GCL**" or "**Game Changers League**" or "**League**"), which feature competitive play of the video game VALORANT ("**Game**"). Game Changers Leagues are part of the second highest tier of VALORANT competition below the VALORANT Champions Tour (the "**VCT**").

1.2. Purpose.

Riot has created this VALORANT Game Changers Championship Competition Ruleset (the " **GC Competition Ruleset**" or "**Game Changers Competition Ruleset**") to set forth certain policies, rules and procedures for the 2023 VALORANT Game Changers Championship ("**Game Changers Championship**") event as part of VALORANT Game Changers.

1.3. Application of the Game Changers Competition Ruleset.

Standardized rules benefit all parties who are involved in the professional play of VALORANT. This Game Changers Competition Ruleset will apply to and be binding on each of (1) the individual (natural person), entity and/or group ("**Owners**") who registered a team to participate in a Game Changers event ("**Team**"), and (2) to each Team's players, managers, coaches, owners and other representatives (the foregoing collectively, "**Team Personnel"**).

1.4. Code of Conduct.

Each Team shall comply with and ensure that all Owners and Team Personnel of the Team complies with the Riot Games Esports Global Code of Conduct. Each Team Entity acknowledges and agrees that a breach of, or failure to comply with the Riot Games Esports Global Code of Conduct by any Owner or Team Personnel shall be deemed a breach of, or failure to comply with the Riot Games Esports Global Code of Conduct by the Team, in each instance even in cases where the Team was not, itself, at fault.

1.5. Disciplinary Action.

Riot shall be entitled to undertake such disciplinary procedures as it determines in relation to any breach of, or failure to comply with, this Game Changers Competition Ruleset by the Team, any Owners or Team Personnel and to impose such fines, suspensions, disqualifications and other disciplinary actions (or

combinations thereof) at the discretion of Riot (collectively, "**Disciplinary Actions**"); and such Disciplinary Actions shall be dealt with in compliance with the Riot Games Esports Global Code of Conduct.

All Team Personnel must read, understand, and agree to the Game Changers Competition Ruleset before participating in any Game Changers League event.

2. Ownership

2.1. Ownership Restrictions

2.1.1. The VALORANT Concurrent Ownership Policy prohibits an owner or operator of a VALORANT team from having ownership or control of, or undue influence over, more than one team that competes in an Official Competition. The VCT Concurrent Ownership Policy applies to all Game Changers Leagues.

2.1.2. An Organization or Team may only own one Game Changers Team across all Game Changers Leagues.

2.1.3. As an exception, an Organization may own a Game Changers Team in addition to another second Team that competes in the VCT or Challengers Leagues.

2.1.4. Organizations or Teams are only allowed to participate in one Game Changers League per split. Any changes can only take effect between splits and must follow the procedures and timeline outlined by the Game Changers officials.

2.2. Recognition of Ownership

2.2.1. The Game Changers League shall have the right to make final and binding determinations regarding Team ownership, issues relating to the multiple Team restriction and other relationships that may otherwise have an adverse impact on the competitive integrity of the Game Changers League. Any person that petitions for ownership into a Game Changers League can be denied admission at the sole discretion of the Game Changers League. Team Owners agree that they will not contest any final determination of the Game Changers League in connection therewith.

2.2.2. If an Owner is found to have any financial interest or benefit or any level of influence in another Team in breach of the VALORANT Concurrent Ownership Policy, the Owner will be required to immediately divest said interest in one of the two Teams and may be subject to Disciplinary Action by the Game Changers League.

2.2.3. Ownership of a Team competing in a Game Changers League should be clearly indicated by the Team to Game Changers officials.

3. Player Eligibility

Note: Certain regions may have eligibility guidelines beyond those already set forth in this GC Competition Ruleset (e.g., players in X region may only compete for cash prizes in esports if they are above 18 years of age). These additional eligibility guidelines will be included in the Game Changers Supplementary Rules for each region. Players must satisfy those additional eligibility guidelines to be eligible to compete in a GC League in that region and the Game Changers Championship.

To be eligible to compete, each player must satisfy all of the following:

3.1. Player Age

3.1.1. No player shall be considered eligible to participate in any Game Changers competition before their 16th birthday, defined as having lived 16 full years ("**Minimum Age Requirement**").

3.1.2. If a player meets the Minimum Age Requirement, but is under the age of majority in their country of residence before the start of the Official Competition of the applicable Game Changers League, they may still compete in the Official Competition if (a) they meet the other eligibility criteria in this Game Changers Competition Ruleset and any Game Changers Supplementary Rules, and (b) a parent or legal guardian accepts this Game Changers Competition Ruleset and any additional Game Changers Supplementary Rules on behalf of the player, and consents to the player's participation in the Official Competition using a parental consent form provided by the Game Changers Officials.

3.2. Player Gender

All players on a Team's Roster must meet the Player Gender requirements of the applicable Game Changers League where the Team earned qualification to the Game Changers Championship.

3.3. Eligibility Vouching

Unless permitted on a case-by-case basis by the Tournament Operator, the Team's starting roster must have played together for at least two (2) weeks prior to the registration deadline for the Game Changers League. The Team must vouch that all of their players meet the player eligibility requirements in both the Game Changers Competition Ruleset and any applicable Game Changers Supplementary Ruleset.

The Tournament Operator reserves the right to reevaluate the eligibility of any player during a Game Changers event. If a player participating in a Game Changers event is determined, at the sole discretion of Tournament Officials, to have misled the Tournament Operator with regard to these player eligibility requirements, all Team members on the player's Team may be sanctioned.

3.4. Residency & Representation

3.4.1. Regional Representation.

In order to encourage the training and development of players in each Game Changers League Territory and to maintain the regional identity of the Teams competing in the Game Changers League and to encourage the type of regional identification that is important to fans and sponsors, each Team must maintain on the Starting Roster (as defined below), at all times during Official Competition of the Game Changers League, at least three (3) players who are Residents (as defined below) of a country in the applicable Game Changers League Territory.

3.4.2. Resident Defined; Certification and Proof of Residency.

A player is considered a "Resident" of a country within a Game Changers League Territory if the player is either (i) a citizen of a country in the Game Changers League Territory or holds additional citizenship rights (such as those of the EU) for that Game Changers League Territory, (ii) a lawful permanent resident, or (iii) the holder of other special status (e.g., refugee or asylum status) in a country in the Game Changers League Territory. Each player must certify their residency by (a) submitting an eligibility form and (b) providing proof that the player holds one of the residency statuses set forth in causes (i)-(iii) above.

3.4.3. Single Residency Status.

For purposes of determining Residency and compliance with this Game Changers Competition Ruleset, a player may only be a Resident of one country at a time.

3.4.4. Dual Citizens.

A player who has dual citizenship or otherwise meets the qualifications to be considered a Resident of more than one country (a "**Dual Citizen**") cannot be a Resident of more than one country simultaneously. Once a Dual Citizen registers with a Team as a Resident of a country within a Game Changers League Territory such Team belongs to (such country that the Dual Citizen declares their residency in, the "**Declared Resident Country**"), the Dual Citizen shall solely be deemed a Resident of the Declared Resident Country.

Between Seasons only, a Dual Citizen may request to change their Declared Resident Country if (a) they qualify to be considered a Resident of such country in accordance with Section 2.2.2 above **AND** (b) one or more of the following applies: (i) the country that the Dual Citizen wishes to switch residency to is in the same Game Changers League Territory as the Dual Citizen's current Declared Resident Country; or (ii) the Dual Citizen was, during the most recent split (or most recent Season if there are not multiple splits), on the Starting Roster of a Team that belongs to the same Game Changers League Territory that the country the Dual Citizen wishes to switch residency to falls within, for at least fifty percent (50%) of the average number of regular season matches played by Teams in the applicable Game Changers League. Declared Resident Country change requests must be submitted to Game Changers Officials for review; approval of such requests shall be granted at the Tournament Operator and Riot's discretion.

3.4.5. Residence Requirement Violations.

Each Team is responsible for ensuring that its players meet these residency requirements. It shall be a violation of this Game Changers Competition Ruleset, by both the Team and the player, if a player (or their parent or guardian) provides false, misleading or incomplete information resulting in the misclassification of such player's residency. Such violation will subject the Team and/or player to Disciplinary Actions.

3.5. Verification

Tournament Officials reserve the right to request legal proof to verify a player's age, residency or compliance with other eligibility requirements in this GC Competition Ruleset and any applicable Game Changers Supplementary Rules. All matters relating to the determination of a player's eligibility to participate in a Game Changers League, shall, for purposes of the Official Competition, be resolved by the Tournament Officials in their sole discretion.

3.6. Media and Sponsor Events

Each player agrees to participate in media interviews, press briefings, streaming sessions, sponsor events, photo or video shoots, charitable events, house tours, webcasts, podcasts, chats and other media events that Riot or the Tournament Operator organize in connection with the marketing and promotion of the an Official Competition, the Game Changers League, and/or VALORANT ("**Media Events**"), provided that these Media Events do not unduly interfere with a player's game preparation or participation. The reasonable and pre-approved expenses incurred by a player in travel to and from a Media Event will be borne by the Tournament Operator or Riot. The Tournament Operator shall have the right to

disqualify any player or Team that fails to attend and participate fully in any scheduled Media Event.

3.7. Player Vetting

3.7.1. As part of the player registration process, Teams must submit the username and Riot ID for their main and up to one secondary (smurf) VALORANT account used in the last 3 months, for each player of the Team, to Tournament Officials. Failure to do so may result in Disciplinary Action.

3.7.2. The vetting process may consist of anti-cheat and behavior checks across the submitted accounts to determine whether or not they are in line with the standards expected of players in the Game Changers Leagues.

3.7.3. Tournament Officials will inform Teams of their players' behavior check results upon completion. This process may take up to 1 week.

3.7.4. If a player fails the anti-cheat and/or behavior check, a report containing information on why the player did not pass vetting will be compiled. Tournament Officials may share this report with the Team upon receiving written permission from the player.

3.7.5. Players that fail the checks may also be subject to penalties depending on the severity of the case. At minimum, players will receive increased monitoring and be expected to demonstrate improved behavior during the next round of checks.

3.7.6. Players that pass the check may still be subject to Disciplinary Action based on the specific results.

3.8. No Riot or Tournament Operator Employees

3.8.1. Team Owners and Team employees may not be employees of Riot or the Game Changers Tournament Operator or any of their respective affiliates. "Affiliate" is defined as any person or other entity which owns or controls, is under the ownership or control of, or is under common ownership or control, with the named entities above. "Control" shall mean the power, through any means, to determine the policies or management of an entity, whether through the power to elect, appoint or approve, directly or indirectly, the directors, officers, managers or trustees of such entity or otherwise.

4. Roster Rules

4.1. Starters & Substitutes

4.1.1. Each Team must maintain, at all times during the Game Changers Season, five players ("**Starters**") in the Team's starting lineup ("**Starting Roster**"). A Team has the option of adding two additional players to act as substitutes ("**Substitutes**").

Note: Travel accommodations will only be covered for one substitute. Tournament Officials have the right to disqualify any Team with an incomplete roster.

4.2. Minimum Roster Requirements

4.2.1. Roster Size.

The Team is required to maintain, during the Game Changers League competitive season, a total competitive roster of no less than five (5) players ("**Minimum Roster**"), and no more than seven (7) players (the "**Maximum Roster**").

All Starters, and any Substitute who replaces a Starter, must be eligible to participate in a Game Changers League competition. Teams must comply with the Minimum Roster requirement at all times during the Game Changers competition. If at any point a Team's roster falls below the Minimum Roster requirement, that Team may be disqualified or otherwise subject to Disciplinary Action, unless given permission to drop below the Minimum Roster requirement by Tournament Officials, at their sole discretion.

4.2.2. Right to Progress

If a Team earns the right to progress to another stage of the Game Changers League competition (e.g., Game Changers Championship), the right is contingent on the Team retaining a minimum of three players that were on their Roster and played at least one official Game Changers League Match during the qualification process.

4.3. Single Team Exclusivity

4.3.1. A player or coach will not be allowed to compete for more than one Team concurrently, and cannot be listed on the Roster of more than one Team.

4.3.2. A player or coach cannot have a contractual or financial arrangement with another Team unless explicitly allowed by the League in writing, except in accordance with the Content Creator Exception (defined below).

4.4. Content Creator Exception

4.4.1. Purpose

This exception to the Single Team Exclusivity rule ("**Content Creator Exception**") is intended to provide an avenue for individuals that are employed or affiliated with an organization ("**Content Creator Organization**") in a role that does not directly participate in or provide competitive support for an active Team in the VCT or Game Changers Leagues ("**Exception Eligible Role**") (e.g., content creators) to participate as a player or coach on a Team ("**Competition Team**") competing in the Game Changers Leagues or its direct qualifiers ("**Competition Team**"), while also mitigating potential conflicts of interest that may arise from such participation.

The Content Creator Exception is not intended to allow organizations to run a second team (e.g., pseudo-academy team) in the Game Changers Leagues, or to allow individuals to compete on more than one Team in the VCT or Game Changers Leagues.

4.4.2. Eligibility Criteria

- **Ineligible Individuals -** Individuals that are participating as a player, coach, team manager, or analyst ("**Exception Ineligible Role**") on a Team in the VCT, Challengers Leagues, or Game Changers Leagues are ineligible. The spirit of the rule is that individuals that directly participate or provide direct competitive support for an active Team in the VCT, Challengers Leagues, or Game Changers Leagues are ineligible for the Content Creator Exception.
- **Eligible Individuals** - Individuals that are affiliated with a Content Creator Organization in a role that meets <u>all</u> of the following criteria are eligible to participate on a Competition Team in a VALORANT Game Changers League or their direct qualifiers under the Content Creator Exception to the Single Team Exclusivity rule:
  - (1) The individual is not affiliated with any organization in an Exception Ineligible Role; and
  - (2) The Content Creator Organization where the individual has an Exception Eligible Role does not have a Team in the same VALORANT Game Changers League as the individual's Competition Team.

4.4.3. Content Creator Roster Restriction

Teams competing in the Game Changers Leagues or their direct qualifiers may include any number of players (up to the Maximum Roster) and/or coaches that are eligible for the Content Creator Exception, but may only

include up to two (2) players and/or coaches from the same given Content Creator Organization.

4.4.4. Sponsorship Restrictions

While participating in a Game Changers League or its direct qualifiers under this exception, individuals may not:

- (1) represent or promote their Content Creator Organization during a broadcast of a Game Changers Leagues or any of its direct qualifiers, including via in-game name, apparel, and/or shout outs; or
- (2) represent or promote the Content Creator Organization's sponsors during a broadcast of a Game Changers Leagues or any of its direct qualifiers.

While participating in a VALORANT Game Changers League or its direct qualifiers under this exception, individuals are expressly allowed to:

- (1) represent their Content Creator Organization through the individuals own social media accounts; and
- (2) represent their Content Creator Organization outside of the broadcasts or official media events of the Game Changers Leagues.

4.5. Submission of the Roster & Team Registration

4.5.1. Before the start of the Game Changers League competition, each Team must register its roster (including all Starters, any substitutes and coaches) using the tools and forms provided by Riot or the Tournament Officials. Except as set forth in the Roster Changes rule, no changes to a Team's roster will be permitted after a Team's registration has been processed without the prior approval of the Tournament Officials (including for changes due to sickness, visa issues, etc.)

4.6. Roster Changes

4.6.1. Roster Lock

A Team may complete trades involving players on other Teams, sign new players or free agents or otherwise change the players on its roster during any time outside of periods where Teams are prohibited from making roster changes ("**Roster Lock Period**s"), using the tools and forms provided by Riot or the Tournament Officials.

The Roster Lock Periods will change from year to year and will be communicated to Teams by Tournament Officials. Unless otherwise agreed to by the Tournament Officials, the addition or removal of a player from the

Team's roster at any time during the Roster Lock Periods is a violation of this Game Changers Competition Ruleset.

Between the Roster Lock Start Date specified for a Team's region to **November 18, 2024**, teams participating in the Game Changers Championship are prohibited from adding any player to their roster without explicit prior approval of Tournament Officials.

4.6.2. Roster Lock Exception

In the event of an emergency that causes a Team to be unable to field a full five (5) Starters in the Team's starting lineup during a Roster Lock Period, the Team may be granted an exception to add players to its roster during the Roster Lock Period. The Team may complete trades involving players on other Teams or sign new players or free agents to add players to its roster in order to field five (5) Starters in the Team's starting lineup. Tournament Officials will determine if an event qualifies as an emergency. Any Player that competed as a Starter on a Team in an immediately prior phase of Official Competition is not eligible to be added to a Team's roster under the Roster Lock Exception.

Example: A Player that competed as a Starter on a Team in a Game Changers Playoffs would not be eligible to be added to a Team's roster under the Roster Lock Exception for a Team that qualified into the Game Changers Championship.

In the case of extenuating circumstances, such as temporary visa issues, a competitive suspension or a medical emergency the roster requirements may be waived temporarily. Grant of this waiver is at the sole discretion of the Game Changers League.

Any player who is dropped from a Team's Roster may not rejoin that Team's Roster until a minimum of three weeks have elapsed after the effective date of the player's prior removal from the Team's Roster.

4.7. Substitutions

4.7.1. Any substitution must result in the Team having an eligible Roster or Starting Roster.

4.7.2. For Matches involving more than one Map (i.e., a best-of-three or best-of-five Match), a Team may replace their then-current Starters with Substitutes in between Maps, provided that the Team informs the opposing

Team and receives approval from the Referees of such substitution no later than five minutes after the conclusion of the previous game.

4.7.3. In the event that a Player disconnects during a map and is unable to return within the allocated pause time, the Team will be permitted to replace them with a Substitute from their Roster. The lobby will need to be remade, and the game manually reverted to the previous game state.

4.7.4. In the event of an emergency at any point during a Match, a Team will be given up to ten minutes to produce an eligible Substitute on-site. If a replacement cannot be found then the Team will forfeit. Tournament Officials will determine if an incident qualifies as an emergency. Any substitute must be an eligible member of the Team roster.

4.8. Team Manager

Each Team must maintain, at all times during an Official Competition, one person who will act as the Team's general manager ("**Team Manager**"). The Team Manager will be designated when the Team completes the registration process and will be responsible for all logistical and operational communications between Riot, the Tournament Operator, and the Owners of such Team. Riot and the Tournament Operator may rely upon any communications from the Team Manager as being made by all Owners of the Team. Any Owner or any Team Personnel, including the Team Captain (as defined below), is eligible to serve as the Team Manager. A Team may not change its Team Manager without providing prior written notice thereof to Riot and the Tournament Operator.

4.9. Team Captain

Each Team must designate one player as its captain when completing the registration process ("**Team Captain**"). In the event the Team Manager is unavailable, the Team Captain will be responsible for all Team communications with Tournament Officials. The Tournament Officials may rely upon any communications from the Team Captain as being made by all players on the Team. The Team Captain must at all times be a player on the Team's roster. For the avoidance of doubt, the Team Manager (as defined below) or any Owner is eligible to serve as the Team Captain, provided that he or she is also a player on the Team's roster. A Team may not change its Team Captain during an Official Competition without the prior written approval of the Tournament Officials.

4.10. Coaches

4.10.1. If a Team has more than one coach, the Teams must designate one (1) coach as the "**Match Coach**" that is allowed to communicate with the Team's players during the Agent and Map selection process for each Match,

timeouts, half-times, in between regulation and overtime, and in between Maps (if applicable). If the Team has one coach, that coach will be classified as the Match Coach.

4.10.2. The Match Coach may be present for every Match in which the Team participates.

- For live, in-person tournaments ("**LAN Events**"), the Team's Match Coach may be on site throughout each such Match.
- For online tournaments ("**Online Events**"), the Team's Match Coach may be connected to the voice communication system in the lobby and will only be allowed to talk to players during the Agent and Map selection process for each Match, timeouts, half-times, in between regulation and overtime, and in between Maps (if applicable).

4.10.3. The Team's Match Coach is only permitted to be in the Match Area during Agent and Map selection, Timeouts, Half-Times, in between regulation and overtime, and in between Maps. For the purposes of online competition, any room in which the player competes will be considered part of the Match Area.

4.10.4. At the Tournament Officials's sole discretion, up to two (2) other coaches and/or Team personnel may be provided with a means to communicate with the Match Coach during the Match. The other coaches and/or Team personnel may only communicate with the Match Coach using the means provided by the Tournament Officials.

4.10.5. The other coaches and/or Team personnel are not permitted to be in the Match Area, and may not communicate with the players during a Match unless authorized by the Tournament Officials.

Note: For Open Qualifiers, the use of "Coach Slots" will be determined by the Tournament Officials and communicated to Teams in advance of the tournament. For Game Changers matches, Coach Slots will be permitted. (Coach Slots Current Functionality: Coaches can spectate Tournament Mode games and are locked to observing the team chosen in the custom game lobby.)

4.10.6. In the event of an emergency, the Team can designate an interim Match Coach. Whether or not an event qualifies as an emergency is determined at the sole discretion of the Tournament Officials. The interim Match Coach can be a Team Manager.

4.11. Player Names

4.11.1. A player's official nickname (Tournament Handle) or Riot ID will be selected at the time of registration and may not be changed at any time without the prior written approval of Tournament Officials.

4.11.2. Tournament Handles may not exceed 11 characters, including spaces, and may use upper-case letters, lower-case letters, digits, underscores, or single spaces between words only.

4.11.3. Tournament Handles must be unique globally. In the event of a conflict, Tournament Officials will notify Teams and request submission of a new name.

4.11.4. A Tournament Handle may not include any word or phrase in any language that is offensive, toxic or hurtful.

4.11.5. A Tournament Handle may not include all or part of a corporate name or make use of the trademarks or other intellectual property of Riot, VALORANT or any third party without the prior written approval of Tournament Officials. In order to secure such approval, a player must provide a license agreement, sponsorship agreement or other documentary evidence to Tournament Officials sufficient to demonstrate to the satisfaction of the Tournament Officials that the player is properly licensed to use such third party's intellectual property. Notwithstanding any approval that may be provided by the Tournament Officials, the entire risk and responsibility for obtaining the right to use a corporate name or the intellectual property of a third party in or as part of a player's name or Riot ID shall be with the player.

4.11.6. Tournament Officials reserve the right to reject any Tournament Handle or Riot ID selected by a player for any reason and to require the player to select an alternate name that complies with this Game Changers Competition Ruleset or the Game Changers Supplementary Rules.

4.12. Team Tags (Tricodes)

4.12.1. Teams will be permitted a team tag of 2-4 characters to be added to the front of each Player's Tournament Handle on the Tournament Realm. These team tags must be a combination of uppercase letters and/or digits, and they must be unique globally in VALORANT.

5. Competition Format

5.1. Game Changers Championship

- Ten teams.
- Ten-team double elimination bracket.
    - The top seed from EMEA and the Americas have advanced seeding.
- All matches are best-of-three; Lower Finals and Grand Finals are best-of-five.

6. Travel & Expenses

6.1. LAN Events

6.1.1. For up to five (5) Starters, one (1) Substitute, one (1) Coach OR Team Manager per Team who have earned the right to participate in LAN Events held as part of a Game Changers League, the Tournament Operator will provide (a) reasonable travel, accommodation and meals while they compete at such LAN Events or (b) provide reimbursement for reasonable travel, accommodation and meals while they compete at such LAN Events.

6.1.2. Players who qualify to compete in any LAN Events held as part of a Game Changers League must have all necessary visas, passports or other travel documents for travel to the city where the LAN Events are held, and agree to comply with any COVID-19 guidelines provided by the Tournament Officials. Players under the age of majority under applicable law may be required to travel with a parent or legal guardian. In such cases, the Tournament Officials may also provide a single parent or guardian for each player under the age of majority with reasonable travel, accommodation and meals or reimbursement for the foregoing while such player competes at the LAN Event.

7. Sponsors

7.1.1. Teams, players, and coaches are encouraged to develop relationships with sponsors and advertisers, subject to the restrictions set forth in this Game Changers Competition Ruleset that are designed to avoid sponsor conflicts and preserve the integrity of competition and the reputation of the Game Changers Leagues, VALORANT, and Riot.

7.1.2. Neither a Team nor any player nor coach shall enter into any sponsorship, endorsement, advertising or related agreement, for any VALORANT line of business, with any person or entity that is determined by Riot or the

Tournament Officials to conduct business within any product or service category that is on the Prohibited Sponsorship Categories List (Appendix 1).

7.1.3. A Team, player, or coach shall have the right, subject to Riot or the Tournament Officials prior written approval on a case-by-case basis, to enter into a sponsorship, endorsement, advertising or related agreement, for any of the Team's VALORANT esports line of business, with any person or entity that is determined by Riot or the Tournament Officials to conduct business within any product or service category that is on the Internationally Prohibited Sponsorship Categories List (Appendix 2); provided, however, that any such business within the Internationally Prohibited Sponsorship Categories List shall only be promoted or otherwise displayed at regional or local events (and not international events). Teams interested in pursuing a regional sponsorship on the Internationally Prohibited Sponsorship Categories List should contact Tournament Officials for more information on the approval process, including lists of certain pre-approved sponsors on the Internationally Prohibited Sponsorship Categories List.

7.1.4. Additionally, a player or coach shall not enter into any sponsorship, endorsement, advertising or related agreement, for any line of business (even unrelated to VALORANT), with any person or entity that is determined by Riot or the Tournament Officials to conduct business within any product or service category that is on the Prohibited Sponsorship Categories List (Appendix 1)

7.1.5. Game Changers Leagues may implement additional restrictions on sponsorship acquisition as defined in the Game Changers Supplementary Rules. Teams are obliged to notify the Game Changers League of the intended acquisition of a new sponsor before the acquisition is finalized. If the sponsorship is classified as a Prohibited Sponsorship, then the sponsorship may not be displayed by the Team or players during the use or play of VALORANT, adjacent to VALORANT related material, the VCT, Game Changers Leagues, or any other Riot-affiliated event.

7.1.6. No person or entity may hold the naming rights to more than one Game Changers Team at a time. A sponsor which holds naming rights to a Team may not sponsor other Teams in the Game Changers League in any capacity. No person or entity acting as an owner, partial or total, or as a corporate officer for one Organization may sponsor a Team of a different Organization through themselves, a direct connection, another Organization they represent, or a proxy.

7.2. Compliance with Brand Guidelines

7.2.1. All sponsorship, endorsement, advertising or related agreements that a Team, player, or coach enters into, and all underlying transactions or actions taken pursuant to those agreements shall:

- Comply with the terms of the then-current VALORANT Branding and Style Guide.
- Not have any exclusivity or other provision that is binding on Riot, the Game Changers League or any other person or entity (other than the Team, player, or coach who is entering into the agreement).

7.3. Decisions Relating to the Prohibited Sponsorship List

7.3.1. Riot may make changes to the Prohibited Sponsorship List. It is the Team's, player's, and coach's responsibility to review the Prohibited Sponsorship List for updates or changes.

7.3.2. Riot or the Tournament Officials may, in its sole judgment, reject or terminate the right of a Team, player, or coach to display an advertisement or sponsorship in any of the categories on the Prohibited Sponsorship List.

7.4. Unauthorized Use of Trademarks

7.4.1. Nothing in this Game Changers Competition Ruleset grants, by implication, waiver, estoppel or otherwise, to a Team, player, or coach any right or license to use the name VALORANT, or any other trademark, trade name or logo owned by or licensed to Riot or its affiliates.

7.4.2. Any unauthorized use by a Team, player, or coach of a trademark, trade name or logo owned by or licensed to Riot or its affiliates is prohibited and will be considered in breach of this rule.

7.4.3. A Team, player, or coach may not endorse or sponsor any product or service in a way that could cause people to believe that the product or service has been endorsed or approved by Riot, the Game Changers Officials or any of their respective affiliates.

8. Uniforms and Apparel

8.1. Definitions.

8.1.1. Team Apparel.

Any article of clothing or apparel that is branded with the logo and/or official colors of the Team ("**Team Apparel**"). Tournament Officials reserve the right to prohibit Team Apparel that is deemed inappropriate or unsuitable.

8.1.2. Official Tournament Apparel.

Any article of clothing or apparel that has been created by the League and branded for the tournament or event ("**Official Tournament Apparel**"). For clarity, only the Official Tournament Apparel created specifically for a tournament or event will be considered Official Tournament Apparel for official Matches at that tournament or event. Apparel created for previous tournaments or events will not be considered Official Tournament Apparel.

8.2. Online Matches

These requirements may be relaxed for online Matches held as part of a Game Changers League at the discretion of Tournament Officials.

8.3. Team Uniform.

Players must wear approved apparel ("**Team Uniform**") to all official matches. The Team Uniform includes the following mandatory elements: Team Jerseys, Legwear, and Shoes.

8.3.1. **Sponsor Logo Placement**. Sponsor logos are allowed to be placed on the Team Uniform. There are no restrictions regarding the number of sponsor logos and the logo placement area on the Team Uniform. Teams may choose how Team and sponsor logos are distributed across the Team Uniform. Teams, however, should refrain from creating the impression that a sponsor is the Team's naming sponsor if that is not the case.

8.3.2. **Regional Restrictions**. GC Leagues may define additional standards for sponsor logo placement at their own discretion at the respective GC League level, and these restrictions will be enforced at Game Changers Championship.

8.3.3. **National Symbols**. Flags and other symbols that represent or symbolize a nation are prohibited from being included on any apparel worn by the Team.

8.4. Team Jersey.

Players must wear official, approved, and identical game day jerseys during all League Games ("**Team Jerseys**"). All Team Jerseys must comply with the following:

8.4.1. **Riot IP**. Generally, Teams may not use any Riot marks or IP without express written permission from Riot. This includes, but is not limited to: the Riot Games logo, Event Logos (as defined and subject to the exception below), VALORANT logos, or VALORANT IP (such as agent art, etc.).

8.4.2. **Special Event Team Jersey**. Teams may submit an alternate Team Jersey that may be used for a temporary period of time (e.g. Team organization's birthday or premier of VCT Champions jersey). Riot may provide written approval for use of the alternate Team Jersey on a case-by-case basis.

8.5. Legwear.

All players on a Team must all wear either pants or shorts ("**Legwear**"). Legwear must match across all players, and may not include a mix of pants and shorts. All Legwear must be either (a) official and approved Team Legwear, (b) non-branded neutral color (e.g. black, white, or gray) Legwear, or (c) Official Tournament Apparel Legwear.

8.6. Shoes.

Players must wear closed-toe shoes. Players may wear any brand of shoes.

8.7. Optional Apparel.

8.7.1. **Head Apparel**. Players may wear head apparel (e.g., beanies, hats, etc.) provided such head apparel does not (a) interfere with the use of competition headset and/or in-ear headphones, such as by covering the players's ears, (b) block the players's face, or (c) block any broadcast lights from illuminating the player's face. The Head Apparel must be either unbranded, Team Apparel, or Official Tournament Apparel.

8.7.2. **Under-Jersey Apparel**. Long-sleeved shirts or sweatshirts may be worn underneath the Team Jerseys provided such apparel does not obscure the Team Jersey. The under-jersey apparel does not need to be the same, however they must be either Team colors or a neutral color (e.g. black, white, or gray). No sponsor logos will be allowed on the under-jersey apparel. Individual player branding (e.g. player [In-Game Name]) and Team branding (e.g. the Team name or logo) are acceptable.

8.7.3. **Over-Jersey Apparel**. Over-Jersey Apparel, including warmups, hoodies and jackets, that are worn over and obscure the Team Jersey, may only be worn on stage if they accurately replicate the approved Team Jerseys or have

been approved in advance by Riot, or (a) reflect the Team's official colors; and (b) are consistent with the Jersey Guidelines (e.g., have a Team logo or lettering on the front and do not have sponsors in places or in sizes restricted by the Jersey Guidelines). Over-Jersey Apparel that are Official Tournament Apparel specific to the event a player is currently competing at, are also acceptable.

8.7.4. **Accessories**. Players may wear a reasonable amount (as determined by officials) of jewelry, rings, bracelets, and necklaces.

8.7.5. **Watches**. Players may wear any brand of watch. Smart watches and any other type of wrist-mounted device that is capable of receiving wireless signals are prohibited.

8.8. Prohibited Apparel.

8.8.1. **Branded Apparel**. Apart from Team Apparel that is official and approved by Riot, players are prohibited from wearing other articles of clothing or accessories that display sponsor logos or other visible words, characters, or other images or messages, other than as expressly permitted by Riot.

8.8.2. **Electronic Devices**. Players are prohibited from wearing any type of smart device, fitness device, or other electronic devices that are capable of receiving wireless signals. Players should seek approval before wearing any type of electronic device with computing capabilities.

8.8.3. **Opaque Glasses**. Players are prohibited from wearing fully opaque glasses during an official match. Fully opaque glasses may be worn during the walkout before the start of a match.

8.9. Approved Apparel.

Players may request the use of additional apparel under special circumstances only. Officials will approve or decline any Team or player request for additional apparel on a case-by-case basis.

8.10. Official Match Walkout Apparel.

Players may request to wear alternative apparel that does not meet these requirements during a walkout for a broadcasted official match. Officials will approve or decline any Team or player request on a case-by-case basis. If approved, the player may wear the alternative apparel for the walkout, but must change into apparel that adheres to the Team Uniform policy before the start of the match. No additional time will be given for the apparel change.

8.11. League Content.

During all pre-match and post-match interviews at a venue owned, operated or leased by the League Entity ("**League Venue**"), or in game-day content created by the League Entity, players must wear appropriate Team Apparel or Official Tournament Apparel. For other content, including analyst desk, features content and shoulder content, apparel guidelines will be communicated by the League Entity in connection with those appearances.

8.12. Coach Apparel.

The Team's head coach and other staff who will be on-stage must wear appropriate attire while on-stage or in tournament-related content, including interviews. Proper attire includes professional attire, the Team Uniform, Team Apparel, and Official Tournament Apparel. If chosen, professional attire includes khakis, slacks and dress pants, skirts and dresses, blazers, button-up shirts, polo-shirts, blouses, and other attire that looks professional.

9. Equipment and Peripherals

9.1. Team-owned Equipment

9.1.1. Permitted Player-Owned or Team-Owned Equipment.

Players are allowed to bring the following categories of equipment, which are owned by themselves or their Teams, into the Match Area (as defined in Section 3.3.) and can use such equipment during the LAN event: (1) PC keyboards, (2) PC mice and cord holders, (3) mousepads, and (4) in-ear headphones (collectively, "**Team-owned Equipment**"). For the avoidance of doubt, players may not bring, use or wear any headsets and/or microphones that are not provided by Tournament Officials.

The Tournament Operator is not responsible for the proper functioning of the Team-owned Equipment. If the Team-owned Equipment brought by a player is incompatible with the Tournament Operator-provided equipment, the Tournament Operator will provide replacement equipment for use by the player.

9.1.2. Required Approvals for Use of Team-Owned Equipment.

All Team-owned Equipment used at LAN events may be subject to competitive integrity checks by Tournament Officials in advance of a Match, including, but not limited to, time blocks designated for the Team to test the Tournament Operator-provided equipment, and before the Team enters the Match Area for set-up time. If requested, the Team must submit their Team-owned Equipment to Tournament Officials at a designated time before the start of the Match. Unapproved equipment or equipment that is suspected

by Tournament Officials of providing an unfair competitive advantage will not be permitted for use in the Match, and players will be required to use Tournament Operator-provided equipment instead. At their discretion, Tournament Officials may disallow the use of any individual piece of equipment for reasons relating to tournament security, safety or operational efficiency or effectiveness. No Team-owned Equipment may be brought into the Match Area if it features or displays any name, likeness or logo of a company or brand which is a competitor of Riot or VALORANT. Tournament Officials reserve the right to request the Team to cover-up a logo or brand on Team-owned Equipment during the event.

9.1.3. Replacement Team-owned Equipment

Players may bring additional sets of Team-owned Equipment to use as replacement in case of equipment failure. The replacement Team-owned Equipment must also be submitted to Tournament Officials in advance of a Match for approval. If a player does not have approved replacement Team-owned Equipment to use in case of equipment failure, then the player must use Tournament Operator-provided equipment.

9.2. Tournament Equipment

The Tournament Operator will provide, and players will exclusively use, equipment in the following categories: (1) PC and monitor, (2) hand warmers, (3) headsets and microphones and (4) tables and chairs. At the request of a player, the Tournament Operator will provide the following categories of equipment: (1) PC keyboards, (2) PC mice, (3) mouse pads, and (4) in-ear headphones. All equipment provided by the Tournament Operator will be chosen, selected and determined at the sole discretion of the Tournament Operator. Subject to the foregoing, the unauthorized modification of Tournament Operator-provided equipment or the use of hardware, software or other equipment that is not provided or approved by Tournament Officials will be deemed cheating. Players must return all Tournament Operator-provided equipment to Tournament Officials when the LAN event is over or upon request by Tournament Officials.

9.2.1. Replacement of League Equipment

If equipment or technical problems are suspected at a LAN event, a player or Tournament Official may request a technical review of the situation. A technician designated by a Tournament Official will diagnose and troubleshoot the suspected issues. Technicians may request that Tournament Officials order replacements of any equipment at the applicable technician's discretion. Decisions regarding the replacement of any equipment are solely at the discretion of the Tournament Operator.

9.3. Computer Programs and Usage

At LAN events, players and coaches are prohibited from installing their own programs and must use only the programs provided by the Tournament Operator. This includes the warm-up area computers. If a player wishes to install a program onto the warm-up area computers, they must first ask a Tournament Official.

9.3.1. Voice Chat.

Voice chat will be provided only via the native system used in Tournament Operator-provided headsets. Use of third-party voice chat software (e.g., Discord) is not permitted at either LAN events or online events, without explicit prior approval of Tournament Officials. Tournament Officials may monitor a Team's audio at the discretion of the Tournament Operator.

9.3.2. Social Media and Communication.

It is prohibited to use Tournament Operator-provided computers to view or post on any social media or communication sites. This includes, but is not limited to, Facebook, Twitter, online forums/message boards, and email.

9.3.3. Non-Essential Equipment.

It is prohibited to connect anything other than permitted Team-owned equipment, or Tournament Operator-provided equipment, to Tournament Operator-provided computers, for any reason. By way of example, this includes devices such as mobile phones or flash drives.

9.3.4. Macros

All macro programs, including software macros and hardware implemented macros stored in on-board memory of the hardware, external to the VALORANT game client are prohibited.

9.3.5. Native Programs.

Players may use the native programs MS Paint and Notepad before and after Matches. Players may not use the native programs MS Paint and Notepad during a Match, and must close out of those programs before the start of the Match.

Tournament Officials may prohibit players from accessing native programs in cases of abuse.

9.3.6. Audio Restrictions

Players will be required to maintain volume levels above minimum settings. Tournament Officials may require players to adjust their volume levels higher if the officials determine, at their sole discretion, that volume levels are too

low. Headphones must be placed directly on a player's ears, and must remain there for the duration of the Match. Players are not permitted to obstruct the placement of headphones by any method or place any item, including hats, scarves or other articles of clothing, between the headphones and the player's ears, except for certain religious articles and/or medical devices (e.g., hijab, dastar, yarmulke and hearing devices). The determination of whether an item qualifies for the religious and/or medical exemption will be made by Tournament Officials at their sole discretion.

9.3.7. Equipment Tampering

At LAN events, players may not touch or handle another player's equipment after a Match has started. Players who require assistance with their equipment should ask for assistance from a Tournament Official.

10. Venue, Competition Area Layout, and Schedule

10.1. General Venue Access

At LAN Events, access for Teams to the restricted areas of venues for official Matches is restricted to Team Members only, unless otherwise approved, in advance, by Riot or the Tournament Operator. Permission to attend Matches is solely at the discretion of Riot and the Tournament Operator.

10.2. Pre-Entry Health Inspection

At LAN Events, each Team Member must verify his or her identity with Tournament Officials prior to entering the venue for official Matches. Additionally, Tournament Officials will have the right (prior to allowing any Team Member or other person to enter the venue) to check such person's health by taking his or her temperature or otherwise taking steps to confirm that he or she is physically healthy. If, at any time prior to or during a Match, Tournament Officials determine that an individual is unhealthy and should not enter the venue, such individual will be denied entry and will be required to leave the venue immediately. If Tournament Officials determine that a player is unhealthy and should not participate in a Match, Tournament Officials may require the applicable Team to provide a Substitute. If applicable law requires any additional or different health inspection, sanitation or public safety procedures, Tournament Officials will have full authority to implement those procedures, and all Team Members will cooperate with Tournament Officials in the implementation of those procedures.

10.2.1. Covid-19 Specific Health Inspection

In addition to the general health inspection described in Section 6.2, the Tournament Officials will have the right (prior to allowing any Team Member or other person to enter the venue) to further check such person's health using the following non-limiting steps: a polymerase chain reaction (PCR) test for

Covid-19 within 72 hours prior to travel to a LAN event, a PCR test upon landing in location of the LAN event, a quarantine regardless of vaccination status, a daily antigen test, a weekly PCR test, and a PCR test within 48 hours prior to departure from the location of the LAN event. The Tournament Officials will have the right to add additional steps to check the health of each Team Member to secure the safety of the LAN event. If applicable law requires any additional or different health inspection procedures related to Covid-19, Tournament Officials will have full authority to implement those procedures, and all Team Members will cooperate with Tournament Officials in the implementation of those procedures.

10.2.2. Health and Safety Procedures

In order to protect the health and safety of the participants and staff of the VALORANT events, the Tournament Operator may, at their sole discretion, implement additional disease control and prevention procedures. These additional disease control and prevention procedures may include, but are not limited to, a mask mandate for the duration of the LAN event, prohibitions on in person gatherings, prohibitions on outside guests, and other disease control and prevention procedures. All Team Members will cooperate with Tournament Officials in the implementation of those procedures.

11. Match Area

The "**Match Area**" is the area immediately surrounding any competition PCs used during Match play at a LAN or online event. During Match play, the presence of Team Personnel in the Match Area is restricted solely to the players of the Teams participating in the Match.

11.1. Team Manager and other Team Personnel

11.1.1. Team Personnel, including managers, may be in the Match Area during the Match preparation process, but must leave prior to the Agent and Map Selection phase and may not return until after the end of the Match.

11.2. Coach Match Area Access

11.2.1. Coaches for Teams participating in a given day's Matches will be granted Match Area access and will be allowed to communicate with their Team during the pick/ban map selection process. No other Team Personnel will be permitted in the Match Area during this time without the express permission of Tournament Officials.

11.2.2. All coaches will exit the Match Area to a designated position promptly after the pick/ban map selection process ends. For the purposes of online

competition, any room in which the player competes will be considered part of the Match Area.

11.3. Wireless Devices

11.3.1. Wireless devices, including mobile phones, tablets, and smart watches are not allowed in the Match Area while the players are involved in active play, including during the pick/ban map selection phase, pauses, remakes, and between Maps of multi-Map Matches.

11.3.2. At LAN events, Tournament Officials will collect such devices from players in the Match Area and return them after the end of the Match. For Online Matches, Players must leave their devices away from the Match Area. This rule also applies to notes and notepads.

11.4. Notes and Notepads.

11.4.1. Players are not permitted to bring any written or printed materials into the Match Area during a Match.

11.4.2. The Match Coach is permitted to bring written or printed materials into the Match Area during a Match. The written or printed materials must remain with the Match Coach in the area designated for use by the Match Coach.

11.4.3. Match Coaches are prohibited from using the written or printed materials to communicate or convey information to the players during a Match outside of timeouts, halftimes, between maps, and other time periods where communication between coaches and players is allowed.

11.5. Consumable Restrictions.

11.5.1. Allowed Consumables:

- Drinks are permitted in the Match Area. During LAN events, drinks are only permitted in approved re-sealable containers. Tournament Officials will provide such containers to players upon request.
- Chewing gum is allowed in the Match Area.

11.5.2. Prohibited Consumables:

- Food is prohibited in the Match Area.
- Tobacco and other nicotine products are prohibited in the Match Area.

11.5.3. Teams may not leave any trash or gum within the Match Area after the conclusion of the Match.

12. Match Process

12.1. Changes to Schedule

Tournament Officials may, at their sole discretion, re-order the schedule of Matches within a given day and/or change the date of a Match to a different date or otherwise modify the schedule of Matches. In the event that the Tournament Officials modify a Match schedule, they will notify all Teams as soon as possible.

12.2. Punctuality

12.2.1. Players and coaches participating in an official Match are required to be fully ready in the respective game lobby no later than the time specified by Tournament Officials.

12.2.2. If a Team is not fully ready at the specified times, Disciplinary Action may be applied.

12.2.3. If a Team or any of their players does not show up at the specified time for any of their Matches, due to unforeseen circumstances, Teams must inform Tournament Officials immediately. Tournament Officials may postpone, suspend or cancel the Match at their sole discretion.

12.2.4. If a Match is postponed, it will be rescheduled to a date within the same or the following week, unless another agreement can be found among Teams and Tournament Officials. The exact Match date will be communicated by Tournament Officials at the earliest convenience.

12.3. Roles of League Officials

12.3.1. Match Operations Lead.

The "**Match Operations Lead**" is a Tournament Official who is responsible for judgments on every Match-related issue that impacts competitive integrity. The role of this person includes, but is not limited to:

- Making the final determination on technical pauses and their appropriate duration.
- Ensuring tactical timeouts are valid and all parties are informed.
- Evaluating bug and exploit occurrences and any potential repercussions.
- Making judgment calls regarding round rollbacks and all other issues that may affect the competitive integrity of the game.
- Coordinating map pick/ban process.
- Making the final determination on all Match Operations Regulations.

12.3.2. Head Referee.

The "**Head Referee**" is a TournamentOfficial who is responsible for pre- and post- Match setup as well as the in-game lobby. Their oversight includes, but is not limited to:

- Checking the Team's lineup before a Match.
- Checking and monitoring player peripherals and Match Areas, if applicable.
- Announcing the beginning of the Match.
- Ordering pause/resume during play.
- Informing Teams of sanctions and Disciplinary Action in response to rule violations during the Match.
- Making Match-related determinations under this Competition Ruleset, including with regard to pauses and stoppages of play.
- Confirming the end of the Match and its results.

12.3.3. Stage Referees

The "**Stage Referees**" are under the direction of the Match Operations Lead and the Head Referee. Responsibilities include but are not limited to:

- Admitting or denying access to the Match Areas, if applicable.
- Carrying out security protocols directed by the Head Referee and other League Officials, and/or in support of this Competition Ruleset.
- Administering the player checklist and enforcing this Competition Ruleset, including directing players to take or refrain from taking any action.
- Communicating with players about any issues experienced, in-game and out.
- Upon request, explaining any bug exploits.

12.3.4. Finality of Judgment.

All decisions regarding the interpretation of this Competition Ruleset, player eligibility, scheduling and staging of the event, and penalties for misconduct, lie with the Match Operations Lead, the decisions of which are final. Match Operations Lead decisions with respect to this Competition Ruleset cannot be appealed and shall not give rise to any claim for monetary damages or any other legal or equitable remedy.

12.4. Competition Patches

12.4.1. Game Changers Championship will be played on patch **9.09**. If deemed necessary due to extenuating circumstances, Riot at its sole discretion may change the patch during the Game Changers Championship.

12.4.2. New Agents - will be automatically restricted for two weeks from their release on the competitive queue. Example: Agent A was released on February 5, so Agent A will become eligible to be used in all Matches on February 19.

- Note: Iso is permitted to be picked during the Game Changes Championship

12.4.3. New Maps - will be automatically restricted for four weeks from their release on the live queue. Example: Map A was released on January 1, so Map A will become eligible to be used in all Matches on January 29.

12.4.4. Additional Restrictions - (e.g. disabling certain weapons) may be added by Riot or Tournament Officials at any time before or during a match, if there are known bugs with any items, Agents, skins, or abilities. New agents and maps may be restricted for longer periods of time at the discretion of Tournament Officials.

12.5. Player Accounts

12.5.1. Players may be provided with accounts ("**Tournament Realm Accounts**") by Riot and/or the Tournament Operator. It is the players' responsibility to configure their account to their preferences. The Tournament Realm Account name will be set to the player's official tournament handle as approved by the Game Changers League.

12.5.2. In the event that tournament realms are unavailable, players will use their main "Live" account as provided during the registration process. It is the players' responsibility to configure their primary "Live" account to their preferences, including setting the Riot ID to their official tournament handle. If a player cannot change their name, they must contact a Tournament Official for support.

12.6. Game Settings

12.6.1. All players will be required to have the in-game settings for blood and bodies turned off.

12.6.2. Titles and gun buddies awarded for winning an event, including Masters, Champions, and Game Changers Champions, may only be equipped by players that have earned those titles and gun buddies.

12.6.3. FPS/Latency text and graph trackers must be disabled during gameplay.

12.7. Pre-Match Setup

12.7.1. Players will have designated blocks of time prior to their Match time to ensure they are fully prepared. Tournament Officials will inform players and Teams of their scheduled setup time and duration as part of their Match schedule.

12.7.2. Tournament Officials may change the schedule at any time. Setup time is considered to have begun once players enter the Match Area, at which point they are not allowed to leave without permission of a Tournament Official.

12.7.3. Setup consists of the following:

- Confirm Tournament Realm Account name accuracy
- Ensuring the working function of all equipment, network connection and DDOS protection.
- Connecting and calibrating peripherals.
- Ensuring proper function of voice chat system.
- Selecting skins.
- Adjusting in-game settings
- Limited in-game warm-up.

12.7.4. Technical Failure of Equipment - If a player encounters any equipment problems during any phase of the setup process, player must notify a Tournament Official immediately.

12.7.5. Players are responsible for ensuring the performance of their chosen setup, including computer hardware and peripherals, internet connection, DDOS protection and power. Issues with this setup are not an acceptable reason for lateness or pausing beyond a Team's allowance.

12.8. Player Ready State & Lobby Creation

12.8.1. It is expected that players will resolve any issues with the setup process within the allotted time and that the Match will begin at the scheduled time.

Sanctions for tardiness may be assessed at the discretion of Tournament Officials.

12.8.2. At the specified time before the Match is scheduled to begin, a referee will confirm with each player that their setup is complete. Once all ten players in a Match have confirmed completion of setup, players may not enter a warm-up Match or leave the Match Area.

12.8.3. Other than with respect to online qualifier matches, all Matches that are part of a Game Changers event will be played in Match lobbies hosted by a Tournament Official. Tournament Officials will decide how the official Match lobby will be created and players will be directed by a referee to join a Match lobby as soon as testing has been completed.

12.9. Media Obligations.

12.9.1. Teams will be required to make available to the media for a minimum of 15 minutes at least one player who is intended to start any Match that day. If a player has started at least 2 Matches in the Game Changers League, the player will be required to have made themselves available to the media at least once during the event.

12.9.2. A Team may not make available the same player to the media for 4 consecutive Match days.

12.9.3. Players will be informed of any pre-Match obligations, including, but not limited to, media appearances, interviews, or further discussion of any Match matters.

12.10. Lobby Setup & Play Restrictions

12.10.1. Match Definition

A "**game**" is an instance of competition on a VALORANT map that is played until a winner is determined for the map. A "**Match**" is a set of games that is played until one Team wins a majority of the total games (e.g., winning two games out of three ("**best-of-three**" or "**Bo3**"); winning three games out of five ("**best-of-five**" or "**Bo5**")). For clarity, a Match that concludes with a Team winning three games out of five will be considered a "Bo5 Match". The winning Team will either receive a win tally in a league format or advance to the next round in a tournament format. In a "**best-of-one**" ("**Bo1**") format, the terms game and Match may be used interchangeably.

12.10.2. Lobby Settings

The official Match lobby will be set to "Tournament" mode with "Overtime: Win by Two" turned on.

12.10.3. Server Selection

For Online Matches, prior to each Match, the Tournament Official will select the server which is as close to equidistant from the teams as possible. Each Game Changers league will have a designated "default" server location in the event that an equidistant option does not exist.

12.11. Map Selection Process

12.11.1. At a time specified by Tournament Officials prior to the start of a match, the map selection process will be conducted. Under no circumstances may a map be played twice in one Match unless all other available maps have been played. When instructed in the Map Selection Process, the Team must ban a map and cannot choose to skip the map ban.

12.11.2. The Game Changers League may modify the map selection process for the competition but must provide advance notice in writing to all participants and receive approval from Riot before doing so. Modified map selection processes will be outlined in the Game Changers Supplementary Rules.

12.11.3. The map pool for Game Changers Championship consists of seven (7) maps: Abyss, Ascent, Bind, Haven, Pearl, Split, and Sunset.

12.11.4. Best-of-One Matches

The better-seeded or "Home" team will decide if they are either Team A or Team B. If the Game Changers League in question has no predetermined seeding, the "better-seeded team" for purposes of this Section will be determined at random. Team A starts the process and the map for the Match will be selected according to the following procedure:

- Team A bans 1 map
- Team B bans 1 map
- Team A bans 1 map
- Team B bans 1 map
- Team A bans 1 map
- Team B bans 1 map

- Map 7 is the only Map remaining
- Team A picks side

12.11.5. Best-of-Three Matches

The better-seeded or "Home" team will decide if they are either Team A or Team B. If the Game Changers League in question has no predetermined seeding, the "better-seeded team" for purposes of this Section will be determined at random. Team A starts the process and the map for the Match will be selected according to the following procedure:

- Team A bans one Map
- Team B bans one Map
- Team A picks Map 1
- Team B picks side for Map 1
- Team B picks Map 2
- Team A picks side for Map 2
- Team A bans one Map
- Team B bans one Map
- Map 3 is only Map remaining
- Team A picks side for Map 3

12.11.6. Best-of-Five Matches

The better-seeded or "Home" team will decide if they are either Team A or Team B. If the Game Changers League in question has no predetermined seeding, the "better-seeded team" for purposes of this Section will be determined at random. Team A starts the process and the map for the Match will be selected according to the following procedure:

- Team A bans one Map
- Team B bans one Map
- Team A picks Map 1
- Team B picks side for Map 1
- Team B picks Map 2

- Team A picks side for Map 2
- Team A picks Map 3
- Team B picks side for Map 3
- Team B picks Map 4
- Team A picks side for Map 4
- Map 5 is only Map remaining
- Team B picks side for Map 5

12.11.7. Best-of-Five Matches for Double Elimination Grand-Finals

The upper bracket team will decide if they are either Team A or Team B. Map picks and bans for the Match will be selected according to the following procedure:

- Upper bracket Team bans two maps
- Team A picks map 1
- Team B picks side for map 1
- Team B picks map 2
- Team A picks side for map 2
- Team A picks map 3
- Team B picks side for map 3
- Team B picks map 4
- Team A picks side for map 4
- Map 5 is only map remaining
- Team B picks side for map 5

12.12. Agent Select & Match Start

12.12.1. Once Agent Select has started, players will have 85 seconds to pick their Agent, with both Teams picking simultaneously. If a player picks an Agent by mistake during this phase, the Player must notify a Tournament Official of their intended selection before the Agent Select timer expires. In this case the Agent Select process will be restarted with the same picks up until the mistake occurred, after which the player must choose their intended Agent.

In the case that the player notifies a Tournament Official after the timer has expired, the Agent Select process will not be restarted and the player will be required to play through.

12.12.2. A Match will start immediately after the Agent/Map Selection process is complete, unless otherwise stated by a Tournament Official.

12.12.3. Players are not allowed to quit a Map during the time between the completion of picks/bans and Map launch, also known as "Free Time."

12.13. Controlled Match Start

12.13.1. In the event of an error in Match start or a decision by Tournament Officials to separate the pick/ban process from Match start, a Tournament Official may start the Match in a controlled manner and all maps will be selected in accordance with the previous valid completed pick/ban process.

12.14. Slow Client Load

If a game crash, disconnect, or any other failure occurs which interrupts the loading process and prevents a player from joining a Match upon Match start, the Match must be immediately paused until all ten players are connected to the Match.

12.15. Restrictions on Gameplay Elements.

Restrictions may be added at any time before or during a Match, if there are known or suspected bugs with any Agents, skins or maps, or for any other reason as determined at the discretion of Tournament Officials.

13. Post-Match Process

13.1. Results

Tournament Officials will confirm and record the Match result.

13.2. Tech Notes

Players will identify any technical issues with Tournament Officials.

13.3. Between Maps

Tournament Officials will inform players of the remaining amount of time before the next Map in the Match, if applicable. For online events, the standard time for transitions between Maps is eight (8) to ten (10) minutes from the time of the last Map's Round until players are required in their seats for the next Map. For offline events, the standard time for transitions between Maps is five (5) to ten (10) minutes from the time of the last Map's Round until players are required in their seats for the next Map. The next Map, if applicable, will commence as soon as both

Teams have confirmed to a Referee or Tournament Official that all players are ready to play and, at LAN Events, in their seats.

13.4. Between Matches

For online events, the standard time for transition in between Matches is eight (8) to ten (10) minutes from the time of the last Match's Round until players are required in their seats for the next Match. For offline events, the standard time for transitions between Matches is ten (10) to fifteen (15) minutes from the time of the last Match's Round until players are required in their seats for the next Match. The next Match, if applicable, will commence as soon as both Teams have confirmed to a Referee or Tournament Official that all players are ready to play and, at LAN Events, in their seats. If all the players are not ready to play and in their seats (if applicable) at the time designated to them by the Referees or Tournament Officials, the Team can be sanctioned for delay of Game.

13.5. Post-Match Obligations.

Players will be informed of any post-Match obligations, including, but not limited to, media appearances, interviews, or further discussion of any Match matters. Players are required to perform these post-Match obligations.

13.6. Results of Forfeiture.

Matches won by forfeit will be reported by the minimum score it would take for one Team to win the Match (e.g. 1-0 for best-of-1 Matches, 2-0 for best-of-three Matches, 3-0 for best-of-five Matches). No other statistics will be recorded for forfeited Matches.

14. Pauses

14.1. Timeouts

Teams are allowed to call timeouts of sixty (60) seconds in duration ("**Timeouts**") two times per map, at any time not limited by half. The sixty second clock will begin when both Teams' Match Coaches are connected and able to communicate with their players. In the event of overtime, each team will be granted an additional Timeout.

14.1.1. Timeout Protocol

Communication will be limited to players and coaches. All Timeouts must be taken within the first twenty (20) seconds of a Buy Phase. Any Timeout taken after twenty seconds will be deferred to the next round, unless the next

round is after the end of the half or the end of regulation, in which case the Timeout will be spent with no additional time given.

Players are not allowed to leave the Match Area at any time during a Timeout.

14.1.2. Timeout Agent Control

During a Timeout, headsets have to stay on and players are prohibited from controlling their agent (i.e., players can not move or use utility during a Timeout).

14.2. Technical Pauses

14.2.1. Technical Pauses Categories

- Suspension of Play (Expected delay: Greater than 10 minutes)

  Examples: player disconnected from game, monitor went black, computer froze for longer than 3 seconds (less time could classify as an equipment check), any programs crashed during gameplay, etc.

- Equipment Check (Expected delay: 3-5 minutes)

  Examples: mouse battery died, peripheral stopped working, audio became bugged, settings suddenly reset, etc.

14.2.2. Technical Pause Protocol

If a player has a problem that prevents the player from continuing play, the player must notify Tournament Officials and request a technical pause. The player must announce the reason when requesting a technical pause, and Tournament Officials will pause the game if the reason is determined to be valid. Player's are not allowed to initiate a technical pause in-game on their own.

If a player uses the in-game function to initiate a technical pause, the player's Team may be sanctioned for delay of game.

Players are not allowed to leave the Match Area at any time during a technical pause.

14.2.3. Technical Pause Agent Control

During a technical pause, headsets have to stay on and players are prohibited from controlling their agent (i.e., players can not move or use utility during a Timeout). Any form of communication including but not limited to text and

voice communication between players and coaches is forbidden during a technical pause, unless instructed to do so by a Tournament Official.

14.2.4. Invalid Technical Pauses

Technical pauses will not be granted for the following non-exhaustive reasons:

- Accidentally hitting power button of monitor;
- Minor audio adjustments; or
- In-ear headphone adjustments.

14.3. Player Emergency Pause

14.3.1. Player Emergency Protocol.

Teams will be granted a maximum of one (1) pause for an emergency situation ("**Player Emergency Pause**") per map in a Match for a maximum aggregate total of ten (10) minutes across the Match. If a Team requires more than ten (10) minutes of Player Emergency Pauses, then the players using the Player Emergency Pause will become ineligible to continue play and must be substituted.

If the Team is unable to field a full five (5) players, the team shall forfeit the Match unless a Tournament Official, in his/her discretion, determines that victory in the Match shall be awarded to one of the Teams. Teams that misuse the Player Emergency Pause for non-emergencies will be sanctioned.

14.3.2. Illness, Injury, or Disability.

Minor player illness, injury, or disability is not an acceptable reason for a Player Emergency Pause. Players may inform Tournament Officials prior to the start of a Match to reserve the right to use the Player Emergency Pause. Tournament Officials may grant a Player Emergency Pause during the Match in order to evaluate the issue and to determine whether the player is ready, willing, and able to continue playing.

15. Bugs

15.1. Types of Bugs

A bug is an error, flaw, or fault in the Game that produces an incorrect, unintended, or unexpected result. Bug classification will be communicated via the Esports Bug List shared with each patch.

15.1.1. Play Through Bug

A "**Play Through Bug**" is defined as a bug that does not significantly alter the competitive integrity of the game. This may mean that there are mitigation steps available or the impact has been deemed insufficient to warrant a disable or remake.

15.1.2. Major Bugs

A "**Major Bug**" is defined as a bug that has the potential to significantly impact a player's ability to compete in the game, significantly alters game stats or gameplay mechanics, and has no reasonable mitigation steps. The determination of impact will be at the sole discretion of Tournament Officials.

15.1.3. Unknown Bugs

An "**Unknown Bug**" is defined as a bug that is not on the Esports Bug List shared with the current patch.

15.1.4. Game Breaking Bugs

A "**Game Breaking Bug**" is defined as a bug whose occurrence undermines the competitive integrity of a round as a whole, and causes the outcome of the round to become undeterminable. Any bugs that fall within this category will be explicitly listed in the Esports Bug List shared with each patch.

15.2. Use of Round Rollback for Bugs

15.2.1. Pre-Damage

If, at the time that a bug occurs in a round, no damage has been directly caused by any player to an opponent in the round, then Tournament Officials may initiate a round rollback for Unknown Bugs and Major Bugs that impact a player's ability to compete in the game for reasons outside of the player's control.

15.2.2. Post-Damage

If, at the time that a bug occurs in a round, damage has already been directly caused by a player to an opponent in the round, Tournament Officials will not initiate a round rollback unless the bug was a Game Breaking Bug.

15.2.3. Round Rollback for Game Breaking Bugs

If a Game Breaking Bug occurs at any time during a round, Tournament Officials will initiate a round rollback to restore the game to the start of the round.

16. Exploit Adjudication

A player-caused bug that has the potential to significantly alter the competitive integrity of the game and provide an unintended competitive advantage. As a standard, regardless of impact, exploit usage is not permitted and if found will result in a penalty, as outlined below.

16.1. Agent Specific Exploits

Non-limiting examples of “Agent Specific Exploits” are detailed in the Esports Bug List. Any use of a bug or exploit specifically listed in the Esports Bug List, or covered under a blanket prohibition will be considered a violation of these rules.

16.1.1. Cypher

All Cypher cam placements that afford an unfair competitive advantage via abusing map textures and/or geometry to prevent the Cypher cam from being destroyed or seen are considered banned exploits. All Cypher cam placements must result in a Cypher cam that is destructible, that is viewable by both teams, and that does not exploit map textures and/or geometry to create a one-way view that provides an unfair advantage. Any other uses of a Cypher cam that are determined by a Tournament Official to provide an unfair competitive advantage will also be considered banned exploits.

16.1.2. General Agent Utility Rule

All uses of agent utility that afford an unfair competitive advantage via abusing map textures and/or geometry to prevent the agent utility from being destroyed or seen are considered banned exploits. Agent utility cannot be used in areas that are outside of map boundaries while potentially providing any useful information or advantage at any point. Areas that are within map boundaries are defined as areas where all utility is (1) destructible as intended for that utility, (2) has the ability to be seen by both teams as intended for that utility, and (3) does not exploit map texture and/or geometry to provide an unfair competitive advantage.

A player shall not alter the utility’s intended purpose and scope of usage by abusing map textures and/or geometry, abusing unintended interactions with other utility, unintended interactions with weapons, or other types of unintended interactions to gain an unfair competitive advantage. Any other uses of an agent's utility that are determined by a Tournament Official to

provide an unfair competitive advantage will also be considered banned exploits.

SPECIAL EXCEPTIONS: KAY/O's ZERO/POINT ability is intended to be usable outside of map boundaries, and is a special exception regarding these rules. KAY/O's ZERO/POINT ability is allowed to be placed outside of map boundaries, and at other locations that cause KAY/O's ZERO/POINT ability to be indestructible and/or unviewable by the enemy players. However, the knife model of KAY/O's ZERO/POINT ability cannot abuse or exploit map textures and/or geometry to travel to unintended locations. For example, the knife model of KAY/O's ZERO/POINT ability may not travel through or inside map textures and/or geometry that are intended to be solid. Teams should clear specific trajectories or end locations for KAYO's ZERO/POINT ability with Tournament Officials prior to usage if the Team is unsure whether that usage complies with this special exception rule.

16.1.3. Agent Character Model Boosting

Players are prohibited from using another agent's character model to boost to a location out of intended jumping range.

16.2. Assessment of Penalties

When assessing the appropriate penalty, Tournament Officials shall take into account the past punishments for the same or similar situation, exploit classification, prior communication, impact, and intent. The following questions and assessments shall be considered by Tournament Officials in each category to apply appropriate penalties.

16.2.1. Exploit Classification

- Is the exploit on the Esports Bug List, and how is it classified?
- If the exploit isn’t in the Esports Bug List, is it similar enough to another that a reasonable person would assume that the classification would be the same?
- If the exploit isn’t in the Esports Bug List and isn’t similar to another known exploit, Tournament Officials should use the other criteria to help inform any action.

16.2.2. Prior Communication

- Has the Esports Bug List been shared with the team and/or player?
- Was the Esports Bug List for the patch version designated by the Game Changers Officials for the event shared within a reasonable timeframe for them to inform themselves and make necessary adjustments?
- If the Esports Bug List hasn’t been communicated at all or in a reasonable timeframe, this should be a mitigating factor.

16.2.3. Impact

- What impact did the exploit have on the round and/or outcome of the map - e.g., Damage dealt, info gained (vision, sound etc.), prevented opponents actions (bomb defusal/plant).
- What impact could this exploit have on the perception of the sport? Could it bring the sport into disrepute?

16.2.4. Intent

- How hard is it to use the exploit accidentally? Does it require a specific set of actions that don't occur in the normal course of play?
- Has the player or Team received penalties for the same exploit in the past?
- Did the player or Team discuss usage in voice comms?
- Did the player or Team notify a referee immediately after the exploit had occurred?

16.3. Types of Penalties

The following list of penalties is a non-exhaustive list. Tournament Officials may, at their sole discretion, issue other types of Disciplinary Actions such as Fines or Suspensions on a case-by-case basis.

16.3.1. Warning

Tournament Officials may issue warnings for a low impact first offense in order to prevent widespread usage of low impact exploits.

Warnings may be issued for unintended bugs that did not give a competitive advantage, or bugs deemed small enough to not have a significant impact on the competitive integrity of the Match.

16.3.2. Round Rollback

Tournament Officials may perform a round rollback when an exploit has had a significant impact on the outcome of the round, but the intent of the player that performed the exploit cannot be determined, or for low impact second offenses.

Round rollbacks may be used for unintended exploits that give a competitive advantage. Tournament Officials shall evaluate the intent of the player that performed the exploit on a case by case basis. If a player contacts an official immediately after the unintended exploit occurs, then Tournament Officials shall consider issuing a round rollback.

Round rollbacks may also be issued for a major exploit that impacts the integrity of the round, but is not the fault of any player or coach.

16.3.3. Round Loss

Tournament Officials may issue a round loss when an exploit has a significant impact on the outcome of the round, and Tournament Officials have determined that the player or team intended to perform the exploit. Round losses may also be issued if a round rollback threshold has been exceeded, as determined by Tournament Officials.

Round losses may be applied using the following methods:

- Roll back to the round where the exploit was used and award the Team that did not perform the exploit the round win via elimination in round rollback settings.
- If rolling back isn't an option, round loss should be applied at the start of the next round. If the current round could result in the map ending, the loss should be applied to the current round.

Round losses may be issued for intended exploits that give a competitive advantage. Intent will be assessed by Tournament Officials. If the exploit is listed on the current Esports Bug List given to Teams in a reasonable timeframe, the exploit will automatically be classified as an intended exploit if considered egregious.

16.3.4. Map Forfeit Loss

Tournament Officials may issue a forfeit loss for a map of the Match in the following scenarios:

- An exploit had a significant impact on the outcome of a map or provided a significant unintended competitive advantage, but the map has concluded and round rollback and/or remake is not possible.
- Second offenses for low impact exploits where round rollback and/or remake is not possible.
- Second offenses for high impact exploits while the map is still being played, and a round loss has already been applied.
- Egregious cases that warrant an immediate escalated penalty, as determined at the sole discretion of the Tournament Officials.

16.3.5. Match Forfeit Loss

Tournament Officials may issue a forfeit loss for a Match when the actions of the Team Personnel of one of the participating Teams has irreversibly undermined the competitive integrity of the Match, including, but not limited to, cheating and match fixing. Tournament Officials may issue a forfeit loss for a Match where one of the Teams used an exploit that would have resulted in a map forfeit loss, but was not caught until the Match had already concluded, and no reasonable mitigation steps are available.

16.4. Finality of Judgment on Bug and Exploit Adjudication

Tournament Officials have the right to assess and make final calls on all exploit decisions. All decisions regarding the interpretation of this lie solely with the Tournament Officials; such decisions are final, cannot be appealed, and shall not give rise to any claim for monetary damages or any other legal or equitable remedy.

17. Crashes and Interruptions of Gameplay

17.1. Discontinuity of Gameplay

If a Match is interrupted for reasons beyond the control of the players (e.g., server crash, mass internet outage, mass power outage, DDOS, etc.), Tournament Officials may restore the round using the in-game round restore feature to the beginning of the most recent round.

17.2. Individual Player Gameplay Interruptions

Matches will not be stopped and rounds will not be restored or replayed in cases where the issue is clearly a player's fault (e.g., mis-buying a weapon, alt-tabbing, turning off monitor, etc.).

17.2.1. Transient Interruptions

Rounds will not be replayed due to issues that cause a short-term interruption in gameplay that does not persist for the remainder of the round (e.g., alt-tab, client minimization, transient packet loss, transient networking issues, etc.). If multiple players experience transient interruptions to gameplay in the same round for reasons beyond their control, Tournament Officials may, at their discretion, determine that a discontinuity of gameplay has occurred.

17.2.2. Crash/Interruption of Gameplay

If a round of a Match has an issue that causes an interruption to gameplay that prevents individual players from playing out the round (e.g., client crash, computer crash, individual internet outage, individual power outage, etc.), Tournament Officials may restore the round using the in-game round restore feature to the beginning of the most recent round in the following scenario:

- "**Start of Round Crash**" All of the following conditions are met: (a) issue occurred during the first minute of the round, (b) issue occurred before any damage was caused to any player's agent by the opposing Team, and (c) the Tournament Official was immediately notified.

- If a Start of Round Crash occurs, Tournament Officials may stop the round early and restore the round.

For all other interruptions to gameplay, both Teams must play out and finish the round. Tournament Officials will evaluate the circumstances of the interruption to gameplay at the end of the round during a technical pause. Failure by a Team to play out the round to the best of their ability will not be considered as grounds to restore a round.

Tournament Officials, at their sole discretion, may restore the round or award a round victory in the following scenarios:

- More than one (1) player is unable to play out the round due to interruptions to gameplay outside of their control.
- An interruption to gameplay caused a Team to lose a round that the Team had already undisputedly won at the time of the interruption, as determined by Tournament Officials at their sole discretion.

18. Match Operational Measures

18.1. Delay of Game

Teams may be sanctioned for delay of game according to the following penalty schedule. Tournament Officials have the right to assess and make final calls on all delay of game decisions. Tournament Official decisions with respect to delay of game sanctions cannot be appealed and shall not give rise to any claim for monetary damages or any other legal or equitable remedy.

The following penalty schedule may be taken into consideration by the Tournament Officials when rendering a decision.

Delay of Game Count Per Match	Penalty
1	Warning
2-4	Loss of Timeout
5	Map Forfeit

The penalty schedule does not exclude the competence of the Tournament Officials to render decisions on a case-by-case basis in light of the particular circumstances of each case.

Fines may be increased per each additional case of repetition.

18.2. Non-Compliance

Players, coaches, and other Team Personnel must cooperate with Tournament Officials and comply with instructions in a prompt and timely manner. Failure to cooperate with instructions from Tournament Officials during a live Match may be sanctioned with delay of game in addition to other Disciplinary Actions.

19. Limitations of Liability

19.1. No Punitive Damages

To the maximum extent permitted by Applicable Law, neither Riot, the Tournament Operator nor any of their respective affiliates or licensors (collectively, the "**Riot Parties**"), shall be liable in any way for any loss of profits or any indirect, incidental, consequential, special, punitive, or exemplary damages, arising out of or in connection with this Game Changers Competition Ruleset, the Game Changers Supplementary Rules, the Official Competitions or VALORANT, or the delay or inability to use or lack of functionality of VALORANT, even if a Riot Party is at fault and even if a Riot Party is aware of the possibility of such damages.

19.2. Cap on Liability

To the maximum extent permitted by Applicable Law, the aggregate liability of the Riot Parties arising out of or in connection with this Game Changers Competition Ruleset, the Game Changers Supplementary Rules, the Official Competitions or VALORANT will be limited to a player's or coach's direct damages in an amount not to exceed US $25,000. Multiple claims will not expand this limitation. These limitations and exclusions regarding damages apply even if any remedy fails to provide adequate compensation. Riot neither assumes, nor authorizes the Tournament Operator or any other person or entity to assume on Riot's behalf, any liabilities in addition to those liabilities expressly set forth in this Section.

20. Dispute Resolution

20.1. Finality of Certain Decisions

All decisions regarding player eligibility, sponsor restrictions, Official Competition scheduling and staging, and violations of, and infractions committed under, this Game Changers Competition Ruleset and the Game Changers Supplementary Rules lie solely with Riot and the Tournament Operator or, at the option of Riot and the Tournament Operator, with Tournament Officials. The decisions of Riot, the Tournament Operator, and/or the Tournament Officials are final and binding and shall not give rise to any claim for monetary damages or any other remedies.

20.2. Remedies

Notwithstanding the foregoing, Riot and the Tournament Operator shall have the right to commence and prosecute any action or proceeding before any court of competent jurisdiction to obtain injunctive or other equitable relief against a Team, player, or coach in the event that such action is necessary or desirable. In the event of a breach by Riot or the Tournament Operator of any of the provisions of this Game Changers Competition Ruleset or the Game Changers Supplementary Rules, a Team, player, or coach shall be limited to his/her/its remedies at law for damages, if any, and in no event shall a Team, player, or coach be entitled to enjoin or restrain Riot or the Tournament Operator from operating any Official Competition, conducting any Media Event or distributing any broadcasts, streams or other audiovisual content. Neither Riot nor any of its affiliates or group companies has any fiduciary relationship with or duty to a Team, player, or coach.

21. Prizes

21.1. Prize Money

Placement	Prize
1st	$180,000.00
2nd	$100,000.00
3rd	$70,000.00
4th	$50,000.00
5th	$25,000.00
6th	$25,000.00
7th	$15,000.00
8th	$15,000.00
9th	$10,000.00
10th	$10,000.00

22. Construction, Amendments and Other General Provisions

22.1. Priority and Conflicts.

In the event of a conflict between (a) any term of this Game Changers Competition Ruleset and the terms of a Team Participation Agreement, or (b) any term of this Game Changers Competition Ruleset and the terms of a Game Changers Supplementary Rules and/or Guidance Document, Riot, in its sole discretion, shall determine the terms that shall govern and prevail. Any remedies set forth in this Game Changers Competition Ruleset, Game Changers Supplementary Rules, or

Guidance Document shall be in addition to, and shall not supersede, any remedies set forth in a Team Participation Agreement.

22.2. Amendments to the Game Changers Competition Ruleset.

This Game Changers Competition Ruleset may be amended, modified, updated or supplemented by the Tournament Operator and Riot from time to time, provided that no such amendment, modification, update or supplement will have the effect of amending, canceling, superseding or modifying any material term of a Team Participation Agreement. Riot and the Tournament Operator may discuss material proposed amendments, modifications, updates or supplements to this Game Changers Competition Ruleset with Teams, it being understood that Riot and the Tournament Operator retain the authority to amend, modify, update or supplement this Game Changers Competition Ruleset without engaging in any such discussions.

22.3. Consents and Approvals.

Whenever this Game Changers Competition Ruleset grants, confers or reserves to Riot or the Tournament Operator the right to take action, refrain from taking action, grant or withhold its consent or grant or withhold its approval or make any other determination, unless the provision specifically states otherwise, Riot and the Tournament Operator will have the right to engage in such activity at their sole discretion based on their own business judgment, taking into consideration their assessment of the best interests of Riot, the Tournament Operator, the Game Changers Leagues, and VALORANT. If any of the foregoing activities or decisions are supported by the Riot's business judgment, then a court, judge, tribunal or arbitrator reviewing those activities or decisions will not substitute its/his/her own judgment for the Riot's judgment.

22.4. Construction.

For purposes of this Game Changers Competition Ruleset, (a) the words "include," "includes" and "including" shall be deemed to be followed by the words "without limitation"; and (b) the words "herein," "hereof," "hereby," "hereto" and "hereunder" refer to this Game Changers Competition Ruleset as a whole. Unless the context otherwise requires, (i) references herein: (A) to sections, schedules and exhibits mean the sections of, and schedules and exhibits attached to, this Game Changers Competition Ruleset; (B) to an agreement, instrument or other document means such agreement, instrument or other document as amended, supplemented and modified from time to time to the extent permitted by the provisions thereof; (C) to a statute means such statute as amended from time to time and includes any successor legislation thereto and any regulations promulgated thereunder; and (ii) the singular includes the plural, the plural includes the singular, the use of any gender is applicable to all genders and the word "or" has the inclusive meaning represented by the phrase "and/or".

22.5. Language

The original Game Changers Competition Ruleset has been written in the English language. In the event of an unintentional conflict in interpretation between the English version and such translation, the English version will control.

* * *

23. Appendix 1 - Globally Prohibited Sponsorship Categories

1.	Video games other than VALORANT
2.	Video game developers or publishers other than Riot Games
3.	Video game consoles
4.	Esports or competitions, leagues or events for video games other than VALORANT
5.	Other esports teams or any owner or affiliate thereof
6.	Prescription drugs
7.	Firearms, ammunition or firearm accessories
8.	Pornography or pornographic products
9.	Tobacco products and related paraphernalia
10.	Companies related to betting and gambling (including bookmakers and betting sites)
11.	Alcohol products (including non-alcoholic beverages marketed by alcohol companies) other than beer and wine products.
12.	Intoxicants whose sale or use is regulated
13.	Sellers or marketplaces for counterfeit or illegal virtual goods
14.	Fantasy esports operators
15.	Political campaigns or political action committees
16.	Charities that endorse religious or political positions
17.	Disreputable charities (by way of example, reputable charities include Red Cross, Stand-Up to Cancer and other similar mainstream charities)
18.	Cryptocurrencies or other unregulated financial instruments or markets

24. Appendix 2 - Internationally Prohibited Sponsorship Categories

1.	Cryptocurrency Exchanges

2.	Beer and Wine products
3.	Products that contain non-psychoactive cannabis-derived compounds, including cannabidiol (CBD)